

USER STORY:

“In software development and product management, a user story is an informal, natural language description of one or more features of a software system. User stories are often written from the perspective of an end user or user of a system”

In Agile software development, user stories are used to express the requirements from an end user perspective.

The format of the user story is:

As a < user >

I want to < perform an action >

So that < I expect.... >

EPIC :

An epic is a large user story which is too big to fit into a sprint. This high-level story is usually split into smaller ones, each of which can be completed within a sprint. In that sense, an epic is a collection of user stories with a unified goal.

There is no standard form or template to use in writing epics. Some teams use the "As a <user>, I want ..." template which is usually reserved for user stories while others just use phrases, an epic can be used to plan ahead and organize your work over several sprints.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA:

What are acceptance criteria?



Acceptance criteria are statements of requirements that are described from the point of view of the user to determine when a story is "done" and working as expected.

This helps the team reduce risk by testing against the same criteria that were agreed upon when the team accepted the work. Acceptance criteria are emerging and evolving and assumed to be flexible enough to change until the team starts working on the story. Anyone in the team like business analyst, QA and developers can help the PO in both creating and reviewing the acceptance criteria.

Advantages of Acceptance Criteria:



Triggers the thought process for the team to think through how a feature will work from the end user perspective



Helps the team to write the accurate test cases without any ambiguity to understand the business value.



Eliminates unnecessary scope that will add no value to the story, in other words, it will keep the right content.

Example of a User Story With Acceptance Criteria:

Customer would like to have an email sent to my normal email address when his account goes into overdraft so that I know that I need to put money into my account.

Acceptance Criteria:

 Input	 Process	 Output
Valid Email Address	Email Validation	Message sent to email address
Invalid Email Address	Email Validation	Flag online profile as incomplete, kickoff snail mail message
Valid Email Address	Marketing Messaging	Marketing message copy matches copy provided by marketing
Valid Email Address	Marketing Messaging	Marketing message design matches the specs provided by marketing
Valid Email Address	Marketing Messaging	Message contains email link that allows the user to navigate to online banking
Valid Email Address	Email Validation	Message sent to email address

Case Study: - 1) Online Shopping Site

- **USERS:** Customer, Administrator of the system
- **USER STORY:** As an online buyer, I want to add a book to my shopping cart, so that I can purchase it.
- **EPIC:** As a casual online shopper, I would like to pay using my PayPal account, **so** I wouldn't have to spend time on entering my credit card details
- **ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA:** 1) Given that I have shortlisted three books in my wish list, when I click on one book, then it gets added to my shopping cart.

Case Study: -2) Net Banking System

- **USER** – Customer, Administrator
- **USER STORY:**
 - 1) As a net banking customer I want to add beneficiary in my account, so that I can transfer money to the added beneficiary”
 - 2) As a Banking Customer, I want to access/view summary of my savings account, so that I know my balance and other details.
 - 3) As a Banking Customer, I want to Login to Net banking so that I can view credit card details.
 - 4) As a Banking Customer, I want to transfer funds within my own accounts so that I can move some balance across my accounts.
 - 5) As a Banking Customer, I want to transfer funds from my account to another account in another bank, so that I can send money to my family and friends who have accounts in other banks
 - 6) As a Banking Customer, I want to add beneficiary to my account, so that I can transfer funds to the beneficiary
 - 7) As a Net Banking Administrator, I want to have the customer’s data backed up so that I can restore it any time in case of issues
 - 8) As a Net Banking application, I want to shake hands with another bank using a specific formatted XML so that funds can be transferred based on the customers’ needs
- **EPIC: -**
 - 1) As a Bank, I want to provide net banking to customers, so that they can perform various transactions.
 - 2) As a Bank, I want to provide an account summary for all the customer’s types of accounts.
 - 3) As a Bank, I want to provide credit card details to customers.
 - 4) As a Banking Customer, I want to access net banking, so that I can access my account and make transactions
 - 5) As an Administrator of the software, I want to access master records so that I can make changes to customer data.
- **ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA:** 1) Customer needs to be logged in before transferring amount. System should check the receivers account number and validate it prior to performing the transactions. If Ok the local account balance is updated and displayed. system should update both accounts concurrently.

